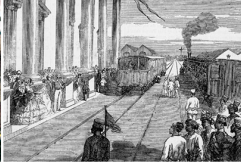
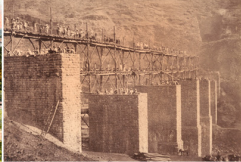


1830 – 1870

The invention of the railways changed the world and how it moved. As with the beginning of any technology, there was a great deal of learning from trial and error. In India, these were the pioneering decades, of establishing the presence of the railways, while negotiating and building the physical, social, and institutional environment crucial to its operation.

1830 The first modern railway, the Liverpool and Manchester Railway, comes into operation, marking the dawn of steam-powered rail travel. 1833 The East India Company (EIC) becomes a purely administrative body through the Charter Act of 1833. 1844 Rowland Macdonald Stephenson's "Report upon the Practicability and Advantages of the Introduction of Railways into British India" is published. This report lays the foundation for railways in India.	1845 The Madras Railway Company (MRC) and East Indian Railway (EIR) Company are formed. 17 August 1849 The "Old Guarantee" System, providing free land and guaranteed rates of return to the private English railway companies is finalized. 20 April 1853 Lord Dalhousie issues his famous Railway Minute. 1855 The Panama Railway is completed, linking the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans. 2 August 1858 The Government of India Act of 1858 transfers powers over India from the East India Company to the Crown. 1859 The Calcutta and South Eastern Railway (CSER) Company is formed. September 1859 The agrarian indigo revolt begins in Bengal. 1862 India's first narrow-gauge line between Dabhol and Miyagam in Gujarat opens. 1862 The Shore Road Project is constructed. 10 January 1863 World's first subway, Metropolitan Underground Railway, opens in London. 1864 Completion of the Kanyana bridge in Delhi links Delhi and Calcutta by rail.			
1830–37	1838–45	1846 – 53	1854–61	1862–70
1832 The first proposal for railways in India is made in Madras. 1837 The Red Hill Railway near Madras, considered India's first railway, comes into being.	1 August 1849 The Great Indian Peninsula Railway (GPIR) Company is incorporated in Britain by an Act of Parliament.	16 April 1853 The first train in India makes its maiden journey from Bombay to Thane. 15 August 1854 The first passenger train in eastern India, from Howrah to Hooghly, is operated.	1856 The Bessemer process to mass-produce steel is developed. June 1855 The Bombay, Baroda and Central India (BB&CI) Railway Company is incorporated. 12 April 1861 The American Civil War begins. 3 March 1859 First train in the north, between Almorah and Kharagpur, begins. 1858 The Eastern Bengal Railway (EBR) and Great Southern of India Railway (GSIR) companies are formed.	1863 First luxury carriage in India is built. February 1862 India's first full-fledged railway workshop at Jamalpur is set up by the EIR. 7 March 1870 The GPRR line reaches Jubbulpore from Itanagar, linking up with the EIR track and connecting Bombay with Calcutta.
				
Opening of the Liverpool and Manchester Railway	Opening of the Madras Railway	Lord Dalhousie	Bombay, Baroda and Central India Railway office	Construction at Bhor Ghat